

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

BOARD ORDER NO. 6-95-35
WDID NO. 6B140100001

UPDATED WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR

BIG PINE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

Inyo County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region (Regional Board) finds:

1. Discharger

Mr. Dennis Tillemans, Operator of the Big Pine Community Services District submitted a completed updated report of waste discharge for the Big Pine Community Services District Wastewater Treatment Facility on December 5, 1994. For the purposes of this Order, Big Pine Community Services District is referred to as the "Discharger."

2. Facility

The Big Pine Community Services District Wastewater Treatment Facility is a facility which discharges secondary treated effluent. For the purposes of this Order, the Big Pine Community Services District Wastewater Treatment Facility is referred to as the "Facility".

3. History of Previous Regulation by the Regional Board

The Regional Board previously established waste discharge requirements for the Facility under Board Order No. 6-87-9, which was adopted on January 9, 1987, Order No. 6-78-16, which was adopted on July 5, 1978, and Order No. 6-70-42 which was adopted on November 19, 1970.

4. Reason for Action

The Regional Board is updating waste discharge requirements in order to incorporate changes in existing flows, treatment plant operations and Regional Board policies. The purpose of this Order is to establish waste discharge requirements and monitoring requirements which are appropriate for the discharge (residential and commercial sewage) and to incorporate recent changes in sludge regulatory policies.

5. Facility Location

The Facility is located approximately 0.6 mile east of Big Pine, Inyo County, south of Highway 168, NE/4, NW/4, Section 17, T9S, R34E, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment "A", which is made part of this Order.

6. Description of Facility and Discharge

The Facility collects, treats, and disposes of an average 0.090 mgd of domestic wastewater from the community of Big Pine. Wastewater treatment is provided by an oxidation ditch followed by two lined oxidation ponds which operate in series. Oxidation pond No. 1 has mechanical aerators which are used in the winter months or as needed to maintain adequate treatment. The secondary treated effluent from oxidation pond No. 2 is then discharged to four evaporation/percolation ponds. The design capacity of the treatment and disposal facilities is 0.150 mgd.

7. Sludge Treatment and Disposal

Sludge is removed from the ponds, infrequently, and dried in the sludge drying beds onsite. The Discharger has no plans to dry or dispose of sludge until the year 2000. Sludge is disposed of at the Bishop solid waste disposal site, Inyo County, or other authorized disposal location. In the Monitoring and Reporting Program, the Regional Board requires a Sludge Management Report to be submitted at least 120 days prior to the Discharger disposing of any sludge from the Facility.

8. Authorized Disposal Site

The four evaporation/percolation ponds at the Facility are the only authorized disposal site for wastewater. The authorized wastewater disposal site is located on lands owned by the Los Angeles Department of Water and Power and managed by the Big Pine Community Services District. The Inyo County solid waste disposal site located in Bishop, California is currently the only authorized disposal site for sludge. Other sites may be authorized with Executive Officer approval.

9. Site Geology

The disposal sites are underlain by alluvial deposits consisting of fine to coarse grained sands.

10. Site Hydrology

Runoff from the site generally flows east to southeast towards the Owens River (Department of Water Resources Hydrologic Unit No. 603.20) which is approximately 1.25 miles east of the disposal ponds. The Big Pine Canal is 0.4 miles to the west of the Facility site.

11. Site Hydrogeology

Depth to groundwater is approximately 15 feet. Groundwater is considered excellent for all beneficial uses. The ground water gradient is in a southeasterly direction.

12. Receiving Waters

The receiving waters are the ground waters of the Owens Valley Groundwater Basin (Department of Water Resources Groundwater Basin No. 6-12).

13. South Lahontan Basin Plan

The Regional Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan for the South Lahontan Basin (Basin Plan) on May 8, 1975 and this Order implements the Basin Plan as amended.

14. Beneficial Uses of Ground Water

The beneficial uses of the ground waters of the Owens Valley Groundwater Basin as set forth and defined in the Basin Plan are:

- a. municipal and domestic supply
- b. agricultural supply
- c. industrial service supply
- d. freshwater replenishment

15. California Environmental Quality Act Compliance

These waste discharge requirements govern an existing facility that the Discharger is currently operating. The project consists only of the continued operation of the existing facility and is therefore exempt from the provisions of California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21000 et seq) in accordance with the California Code of Regulations Title 14, Section 15301.

16. Notification of Interested Parties

The Regional Board has notified the Discharger and interested parties of its intent to update waste discharge requirements for the discharge.

17. Consideration of Public Comments

The Regional Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the Discharger shall comply with the following:

I. DISCHARGE SPECIFICATIONS

A. Discharge/Effluent Limitations

1. The average daily effluent flow of wastewater to the Facility shall not exceed 0.150 million gallons.
2. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal site shall not contain pollutant concentrations in excess of the following limits:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Mean¹</u>	<u>Maximum</u>
BOD ²	mg/l	30	45
MBAS ³	mg/l	1.0	2.0

3. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal site shall have a pH of not less than 6 pH units nor more than 9 pH units. A pH over 9.0 is allowed if it results from a biological process within the treatment plant.
4. All wastewater made available for percolation at the authorized disposal site shall have a dissolved oxygen concentration of not less than 1.0 mg/l.

B. Receiving Water Limitations

The discharge of waste shall not cause the presence of the following substances or conditions in ground waters of the Owens Valley Groundwater Basin:

1. Any perceptible color, odor, taste or foaming.
2. Coliform organisms attributable to human wastes.
3. Toxic substances in concentrations that individually, collectively, or cumulatively cause detrimental physiological responses in human, plants, animals, or aquatic life.

¹ The arithmetic mean of lab results for effluent samples collected in a period of 30 consecutive days.

² Biochemical Oxygen Demand (5 day, 20°C). Samples from oxidation ponds and other pond-type systems should be filtered (using a No. 1 Whatman filter, or equivalent) and reseeded with unfiltered sample. Other types of treatment units should analyze unfiltered samples.

³ Methylene Blue Active Substances

4. Identifiable chlorinated hydrocarbons, organophosphates, carbamates, and other pesticide and herbicide groups, in summations, in excess of the lowest detectable levels.
5. Concentrations of chemical constituents in excess of the maximum contaminant levels or secondary maximum contaminant levels based upon drinking water standards specified by the more restrictive of the California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 4, Chapter 15, or 40 CFR, Part 141.

C. General Requirements and Prohibitions

1. There shall be no discharge, bypass, or diversion of raw or partially treated sewage, sewage sludge, grease, or oils from the collection, transport, treatment, or disposal facilities to adjacent land areas or surface waters.
2. Surface flow or visible discharge of sewage or sewage effluent at, or from, the authorized disposal site to adjacent land areas or surface waters is prohibited.
3. The vertical distance between the liquid surface elevation and the lowest point of a pond dike or the invert of an overflow structure shall not be less than two (2) feet.
4. The discharge shall not cause a pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code, or a threatened pollution.
5. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
6. The discharge of wastewater except to the authorized disposal site is prohibited.
7. The integrity of any pond liners shall be maintained throughout the life of the ponds and shall not be diminished as the result of any maintenance or cleaning operation.

II. PROVISIONS

A. Rescission of Waste Discharge Requirements

Board Order No. 6-87-9 is hereby rescinded.

B. Standard Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated September 1, 1994, in Attachment "B", which is made part of this Order.

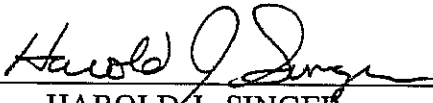
C. Monitoring and Reporting

1. Pursuant to Section 13267(b) of the California Water Code, the Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 95-35 as specified by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of the Monitoring and Reporting Program.

D. Operator Certification

The Discharger's wastewater treatment plant shall be supervised by personnel possessing a wastewater treatment plant operator certificate of appropriate grade pursuant to *Regulations for Wastewater Treatment Plant Operator Certification and Plant Classification*, Title 23, California Code of Regulations, Division 4, Chapter 14, Section 3670 et. seq.

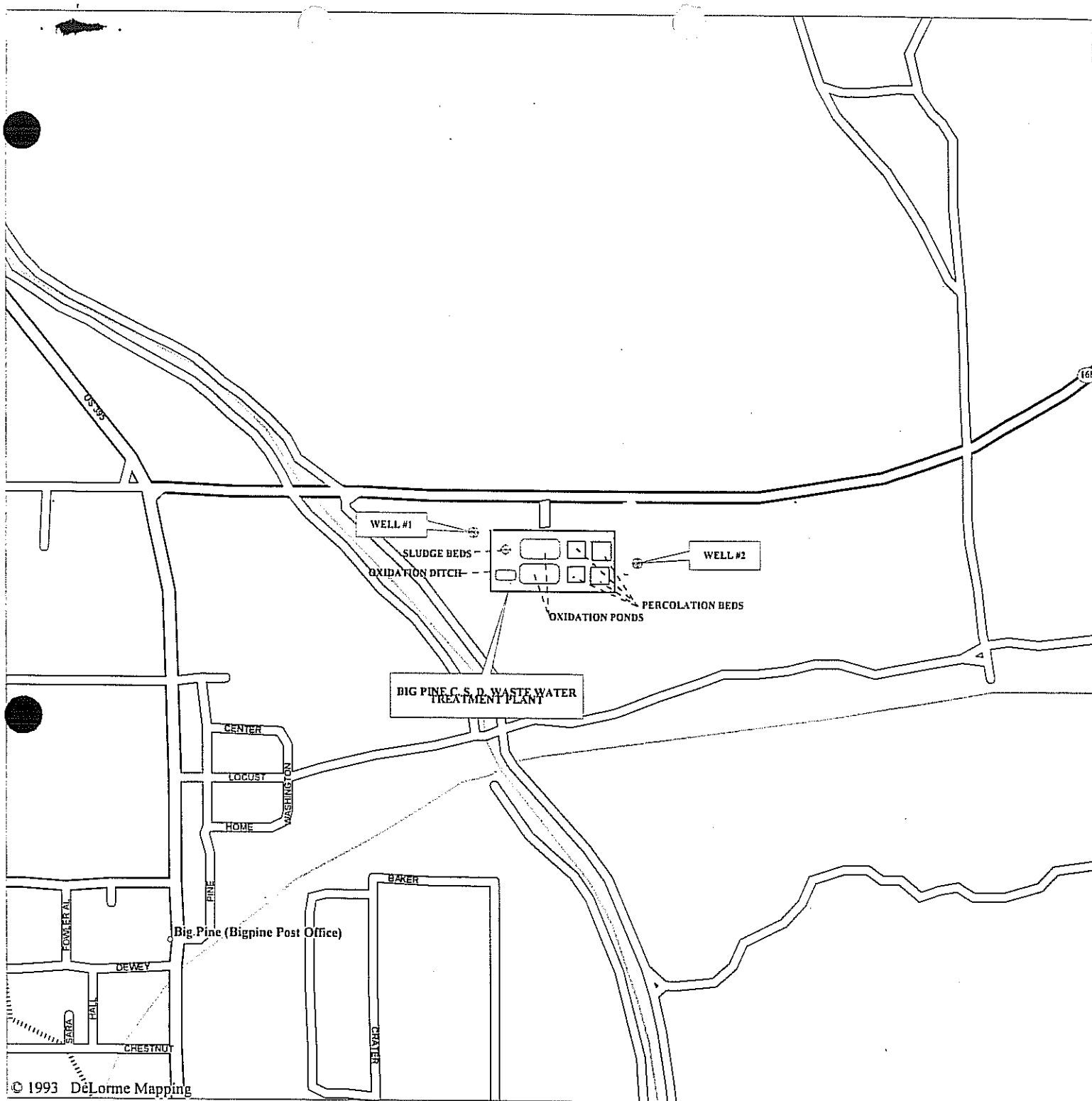
I, Harold J. Singer, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region, on March 9, 1995.



HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Attachments:

- A. Location Map
- B. Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements



LEGEND

- Population Center
- Street, Road
- State Route
- US Highway
- River
- Open Water
- Contour
- Utility (powerline)

Scale 1:10,937 (at center)

1000 Feet

200 Meters

Attachment "A"

Location Map:

Big Pine Community Service District
Waste Water Treatment Plant

Location: 0.6 mile east of Big Pine, Inyo County,
south of Highway 168, NE/4, NW/4, Section 17,
T9S, R34E, MDB&M.

ATTACHMENT "B"

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

STANDARD PROVISIONS
FOR WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

1. Inspection and Entry

The discharger shall permit Regional Board staff:

- a. to enter upon premises in which an effluent source is located or in which any required records are kept;
- b. to copy any records relating to the discharge or relating to compliance with the waste discharge requirements;
- c. to inspect monitoring equipment or records; and
- d. to sample any discharge.

2. Reporting Requirements

- a. Pursuant to California Water Code 13267(b), the discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board by telephone whenever an adverse condition occurred as a result of this discharge; written confirmation shall follow within two weeks. An adverse condition includes, but is not limited to, spills of petroleum products or toxic chemicals, or damage to control facilities that could affect compliance.
- b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260 (c), any proposed material change in the character of the waste, manner or method of treatment or disposal, increase of discharge, or location of discharge, shall be reported to the Regional Board at least 120 days in advance of implementation of any such proposal. This shall include, but not be limited to, all significant soil disturbances.
- c. The owner(s) of, and discharger upon, property subject to waste discharge requirements shall be considered to have a continuing responsibility for ensuring compliance with applicable waste discharge requirements in the operations or use of the owned property. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any change in the ownership and/or operation of property subject to the waste discharge requirements shall be reported to the Regional Board. Notification of applicable waste discharge requirements shall be furnished in writing to the new owners and/or operators and a copy of such notification shall be sent to the Regional Board.
- d. If a discharger becomes aware that any information submitted to the Regional Board is incorrect, the discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board, in writing, and correct that information.
- e. Reports required by the waste discharge requirements, and other information requested by the Regional Board, must be signed by a duly authorized

- e. Reports required by the waste discharge requirements, and other information requested by the Regional Board, must be signed by a duly authorized representative of the discharger. Under Section 13268 of the California Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1000) for each day of violation.
- f. If the discharger becomes aware that their waste discharge requirements are no longer needed (because the project will not be built or the discharge will cease) the discharger shall notify the Regional Board in writing and request that their waste discharge requirements be rescinded.

3. Right to Revise Waste Discharge Requirements

The Board reserves the privilege of changing all or any portion of the waste discharge requirements upon legal notice to and after opportunity to be heard is given to all concerned parties.

4. Duty to Comply

Failure to comply with the waste discharge requirements may constitute a violation of the California Water Code and is grounds for enforcement action or for permit termination, revocation and reissuance, or modification.

5. Duty to Mitigate

The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize or prevent any discharge in violation of the waste discharge requirements which has a reasonable likelihood of adversely affecting human health or the environment.

6. Proper Operation and Maintenance

The discharger shall at all times properly operate and maintain all facilities and systems of treatment and control (and related appurtenances) that are installed or used by the discharger to achieve compliance with the waste discharge requirements. Proper operation and maintenance includes adequate laboratory control, where appropriate, and appropriate quality assurance procedures. This provision requires the operation of backup or auxiliary facilities or similar systems that are installed by the discharger, when necessary to achieve compliance with the conditions of the waste discharge requirements.

7. Waste Discharge Requirement Actions

The waste discharge requirements may be modified, revoked and reissued, or terminated for cause. The filing of a request by the discharger for waste discharge requirement modification, revocation and reissuance, termination, or a notification of planned changes or anticipated noncompliance, does not stay any of the waste discharge requirements conditions.

8. Property Rights

The waste discharge requirements do not convey any property rights of any sort, or any exclusive privileges, nor does it authorize any injury to private property or any invasion of personal rights, nor any infringement of federal, state or local laws or regulations.

9. Enforcement

The California Water Code provides for civil liability and criminal penalties for violations or threatened violations of the waste discharge requirements including imposition of civil liability or referral to the Attorney General.

10. Availability

A copy of the waste discharge requirements shall be kept and maintained by the discharger and be available at all times to operating personnel.

11. Severability

Provisions of the waste discharge requirements are severable. If any provision of the requirements is found invalid, the remainder of the requirements shall not be affected.

12. Public Access

General public access shall be effectively excluded from treatment and disposal facilities.

13. Transfers

Providing there is no material change in the operation of the facility, this Order may be transferred to a new owner or operation. The owner/operator must request the transfer in writing and receive written approval from the Regional Board Executive Officer.

14. Definitions

- a. "Surface waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, live streams, either perennial or ephemeral, which flow in natural or artificial water courses and natural lakes and artificial impoundments of waters. "Surface waters" does not include artificial water courses or impoundments used exclusively for wastewater disposal.
- b. "Ground waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, all subsurface waters being above atmospheric pressure and the capillary fringe of these waters.

15. Storm Protection

All facilities used for collection, transport, treatment, storage, or disposal of waste shall be adequately protected against overflow, washout, inundation, structural damage or a significant reduction in efficiency resulting from a storm or flood having a recurrence interval of once in 100 years.

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 95-35
WDID NO. 6B140100001

FOR

BIG PINE COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY

Inyo County

I. MONITORING

A. Flow Monitoring

The Discharger shall monitor the following:

1. The total volume, in million gallons, of wastewater flow to the treatment facility for each month.
2. The average flow rate, in million gallons per day (mgd), of wastewater to the treatment facility calculated for each month.
3. The freeboard (distance from the top of the lowest part of the dike to the wastewater surface in the pond) measured each month in each surface impoundment. If a surface impoundment does not contain wastewater, indicate that it is empty.

B. Plant Effluent Monitoring

Beginning in April 1995, grab samples of the effluent from oxidation pond No. 2 shall be collected and analyzed to determine the magnitude of the following parameters:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Biochemical Oxygen Demand (filtered)	mg/l	Monthly
Methylene Blue Active Substances	mg/l	Quarterly

C. Ground Water Monitoring

Grab samples from the entire thickness or the upper 20 feet, whichever is less, of the uppermost ground water bearing zone shall be collected from the monitoring wells and analyzed to determine the magnitude of the following parameters:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Nitrate Nitrogen	mg/l as N	Semi-Annually (Apr, Oct)
Purgeable Organics* (EPA Test Method No. 624)	µg/l	Annually
Base/Neutral and Acids Extractable Organics* (EPA Test Method No. 625)	µg/l	Annually

* Analysis shall be conducted for those substances included on the EPA list of priority pollutants and all other toxic substances known to be discharged to the Discharger's system.

1. Each time a monitoring well is sampled, and prior to well purging as specified below, the elevation (mean sea level) and depth (below ground surface) of ground water in each well shall be measured, and reported with the results of ground water analyses.

2. Well Purging

- a. Ground water samples shall be collected only after at least three volumes of water in the well casing have been removed or temperature, electrical conductivity, and pH measurements of the water in the well have stabilized to approximately $\pm 10\%$ for each successive well volume removed.
- b. If measured, the last three measurements of temperature, electrical conductivity and pH during purging shall be reported with the results of ground water analyses. Parameter values shall be reported in the following units:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>
Temperature	°C or °F
Electrical Conductivity	mmhos/cm or dS/m
pH	pH units

- c. If the measurements in No. (2) are not made, the well casing diameter, well depth, and total volume purged prior to sampling shall be reported with the results of ground water analyses.
3. The direction of ground water flow under the facility site shall be determined at least annually unless it can be shown that no changes have occurred.

D. Sludge Monitoring

1. The Discharger shall submit a Sludge Management Plan Report by at least 120 days prior to disposing any wastewater sludge from the Facility.
2. The Discharger shall provide information on any deviations from the Sludge Management Plan.
3. Total quantity of sludge generated (cleaned from any ponds) during the monitoring period.
4. Date and quantity of any sludge landfilled or moved offsite, recipient (including name and address), location of receiving area, and sludge disposal method (including crops grown, if applicable).
5. Cumulative total quantity of sludge currently stockpiled onsite, including the quantity of sludge added to the stockpile during the monitoring period.
6. For sewage sludge removed from ponds, stockpiled onsite, or discharged offsite during the previous month, a representative composite sample shall be collected and analyzed for the following constituents:
 - a. total Kjeldahl nitrogen as N
 - b. ammonia nitrogen as N
 - c. nitrate nitrogen as N
 - d. total phosphate as P
 - e. organic and inorganic persistent and bioaccumulative toxic substances listed in Section 66261.24, subsections (a)(2)(A) and (a)(2)(B), of Title 22, Division 4.5, Chapter 11, Article 3 of the California Code of Regulations.
7. The Discharger shall make a determination whether the analyses in 6.e above, indicate that the sludge shall be considered a toxic hazardous material.
8. At least 90 days prior to sample collection and analysis, a sludge sampling protocol shall be submitted to the Executive Officer for approval.

II. REPORTING

A. General Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of this Monitoring and Reporting Program.

B. Submittal Periods

By not later April 15, 1995, the Discharger shall submit a monitoring report including the preceding information to the Regional Board. Subsequent monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the 15th day following each quarter.

C. Annual Report

By January 15 of each year, the Discharger shall submit an annual report along with the report to the Regional Board with the results of the annual monitoring and the following additional information:

1. The compliance record, and corrective actions taken or planned which may be needed to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.
2. Tabular presentation of the monitoring data obtained for the previous year.

Ordered by: Harold J. Singer Dated: Mar 9, 1995
HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Attachments: General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

GENERAL PROVISIONS
FOR MONITORING AND REPORTING

1. **SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS**

- a. All analyses shall be performed in accordance with the current edition(s) of the following documents:
 - i. Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater
 - ii. Methods for Chemical Analysis of Water and Wastes, EPA
- b. All analyses shall be performed in a laboratory certified to perform such analyses by the California State Department of Health Services or a laboratory approved by the Regional Board Executive Officer. Specific methods of analysis must be identified on each laboratory report.
- c. Any modifications to the above methods to eliminate known interferences shall be reported with the sample results. The methods used shall also be reported. If methods other than EPA-approved methods or Standard Methods are used, the exact methodology must be submitted for review and must be approved by the Regional Board Executive Officer prior to use.
- d. The discharger shall establish chain-of-custody procedures to insure that specific individuals are responsible for sample integrity from commencement of sample collection through delivery to an approved laboratory. Sample collection, storage, and analysis shall be conducted in accordance with an approved Sampling and Analysis Plan (SAP). The most recent version of the approved SAP shall be kept at the facility.
- e. The discharger shall calibrate and perform maintenance procedures on all monitoring instruments and equipment to ensure accuracy of measurements, or shall insure that both activities will be conducted. The calibration of any wastewater flow measuring device shall be recorded and maintained in the permanent log book described in 2.b, below.
- f. A grab sample is defined as an individual sample collected in fewer than 15 minutes.
- g. A composite sample is defined as a combination of no fewer than eight individual samples obtained over the specified sampling period at equal intervals. The volume of each individual sample shall be proportional to the discharge flow rate at the time of sampling. The sampling period shall equal the discharge period, or 24 hours, whichever period is shorter.

2. OPERATIONAL REQUIREMENTS

a. Sample Results

Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), the discharger shall maintain all sampling and analytical results including: strip charts; date, exact place, and time of sampling; date analyses were performed; sample collector's name; analyst's name; analytical techniques used; and results of all analyses. Such records shall be retained for a minimum of three years. This period of retention shall be extended during the course of any unresolved litigation regarding this discharge, or when requested by the Regional Board.

b. Operational Log

Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), an operation and maintenance log shall be maintained at the facility. All monitoring and reporting data shall be recorded in a permanent log book.

3. REPORTING

a. For every item where the requirements are not met, the discharger shall submit a statement of the actions undertaken or proposed which will bring the discharge into full compliance with requirements at the earliest time, and shall submit a timetable for correction.

b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), all sampling and analytical results shall be made available to the Regional Board upon request. Results shall be retained for a minimum of three years. This period of retention shall be extended during the course of any unresolved litigation regarding this discharge, or when requested by the Regional Board.

c. The discharger shall provide a brief summary of any operational problems and maintenance activities to the Board with each monitoring report. Any modifications or additions to, or any major maintenance conducted on, or any major problems occurring to the wastewater conveyance system, treatment facilities, or disposal facilities shall be included in this summary.

d. Monitoring reports shall be signed by:

i. In the case of a corporation, by a principal executive officer at least of the level of vice-president or his duly authorized representative, if such representative is responsible for the overall operation of the facility from which the discharge originates;

ii. In the case of a partnership, by a general partner;

iii. In the case of a sole proprietorship, by the proprietor; or

- iv. In the case of a municipal, state or other public facility, by either a principal executive officer, ranking elected official, or other duly authorized employee.
- e. Monitoring reports are to include the following:
 - i. Name and telephone number of individual who can answer questions about the report.
 - ii. The Monitoring and Reporting Program Number.
 - iii. WDID Number.
- f. Modifications

This Monitoring and Reporting Program may be modified at the discretion of the Regional Board Executive Officer.

4. NONCOMPLIANCE

Under Section 13268 of the Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation.